

4.9b

Chairing: managing the discussion

Worksheet

D Choose three students then practise this short dialogue from the middle of a meeting:

- Chairperson:** So, Hilary, you're going to prepare a short report. Can you circulate it before the next meeting? Thanks. Now, shall we turn to the question of the advertising campaign?
- Student B:** Sorry for interrupting, but I'd just like to go back for a moment to item three on the agenda. Did we decide to have soup or orange juice in the drinks machine?
- Chairperson:** Soup, I think, but coming back to what I was saying, we need to discuss next year's advertising campaign.
- Student C:** Can I just come in here? It seems to me that we made a very bad decision in relation to the drinks machine.
- Chairperson:** I think this is a bit of a side-track. I thought we finished that agenda item. Can we get back to the main point?
- Student C:** Sorry, can I just finish? I'm absolutely certain that most of our visitors prefer orange juice to soup.
- Chairperson:** Right. We'll have orange juice then. Now, can we move on to discuss the advertising campaign please? Who would like to begin?
- Student B:** Well, in my opinion we should use posters all over the metro ...
- Student C:** No, no, no, it's much better to use magazines.
- Chairperson:** One at a time, please. First (Student B), then (Student C).

E Complete the table with the underlined phrases from section D.

Letting one person speak	Can we start with Sergei?
	1 _____
Trying to return to the main point	Perhaps we should leave that until the next meeting?
	2 _____
	3 _____
Changing to a new topic	Well, I think that covers everything on that point.
	4 _____
	5 _____

- Which single word in the dialogue is used for summarizing? _____
- Which single word in the dialogue is used for taking control of the discussion? _____

F Have a short meeting to discuss the social program for your group. Study the agenda and your role notes before you begin.

Agenda

- 1 Group lunch. which day? where?
- 2 Social or cultural trip next weekend: where? arrangements?

Participants Take part in the meeting in a serious, helpful way. However, each person also has a topic not relevant to anyone else that he/she wants to discuss (decide what it is before you start). Try, without being too rude, to direct the conversation towards your topic.

Chairperson Chair the meeting. Try to focus the discussion on the main points and avoid side-tracks. After some time let another student practise chairing the meeting.

At this point I'm going to hand over the chair to ...